



ergonomic devices



Although the split keyboard design is supposed to be ergonomic, it's subject to what one is used to

Gel Wrist Rests

If you don't fancy buying a new keyboard or mouse, but at the same time want to avoid Carpal Tunnel Syndrome (CTS) and Repetitive Strain Injury (RSI), then you need to have adequate support for your palms so that the wrists remain in line with the hands. This can be achieved through the use of gel wrist rests.

We tested the Staples 502451, Gel Keyboard WristRest Black as well as the 502499, Gel WristRest Black. The Keyboard WristRest was long and it covered the entire length of the keyboard, while the other WristRest was just enough for the mouse. The bases of these wrist rests have a rubber grip so that they do not move while typing or using the



mouse. These gel rests have the right amount of softness to give enough resistance to support your palms.

While typing with the keyboard wrist rest, the palm of your hand gets the support it needs, thereby removing the strain on the wrist. The same is the case when using the mouse rest.

These gel wrists rests are really effective at removing the strain on your wrists. They are easily available at Staples and the mouse rest costs Rs. 99, while the keyboard rest costs Rs. 199. If you are a gamer we would suggest you buy the mouse rest, while if your work involves a lot of typing then you should definitely look at the keyboard gel rest.

ergonomic as it can get. We love the keys, we love the functions and we love the keyboard in general. The mouse is brilliant as an office tool and the fact that it looks very up-market may also do a lot for the look of your desktop space. This combo is probably more than most users will be able to fully utilise, so it's largely overkill, but anybody looking at a quality combo will probably end up shopping for one of these. Its price of Rs 11,495 will make most users flinch and feel it's a tad overpriced. At a price of around Rs. 7,500 we would gobble up this deal. Incidentally, the MX Revolution is available at an MRP of Rs. 7,495 and street prices are as low as Rs. 5,000 — which we reckon is a steal for what is arguably one of the most functionally productive mice we've used.

Logitech Desktop Wave: Tidal wave of comfort

The Logitech Wave has been aptly named. While the mouse's design itself brings nothing remotely wave-like to mind, the keyboard has a slight raise in the centre that causes the keys towards the middle to be slightly raised. This slight undulation does not affect the top portion of the keyboard where the function keys lie; instead it is in the region of the alphabet keys and this gives this product its name. The keyboard itself is well laid out and the keys have a similar gap to that we found on the MX 5500's keyboard — it seems Logitech is not following any standard for gaps between keys. However the keys themselves are well bevelled and easy to use. Feedback is poles apart from the MX 5500's keyboard, while that lacked much feedback and could be termed as slightly squishy, the keys on this one exude a lot of positive feedback and there is a feeling of the key rebounding back after being pressed — very good feedback. However, feedback is a double edged sword that compro-

mises on comfort levels and after spending some four hours typing non-stop we'd have to agree that the soft, minimal feedback of the MX 5500 kept our finger pads in much better shape. However, for non-touch typists this sort of a keyboard is easier to use, it'll also be easier for newbies unfamiliar with the layout of a keyboard.

There are fewer shortcut buttons on the Wave than on the MX 5500, but the keys themselves are larger and much easier to use on account of their more positive feedback. There is a useful document flip button that is quite conveniently located to the left of the alphabet keys. The two-way zoom button is large and also easy to use, as are the other multimedia keys. Once again, as with the MX 5500's keyboard, all the function keys have secondary functions that are activated by a dedicated function key. Dedicated buttons for Media Centre and calculator have also been provided. All the dedicated shortcut buttons have a steel grey colour and this makes them really stand out in comparison to the other keys which are a generic black. There is no backlighting whatsoever and the Wave's keyboard makes do without any sort of display. The keyboard has a really soft-foamed wrist rest and for the first time we actually found our palms and wrists could rest very comfortably, sans sweat and any sort of itchiness after extended periods of time. The palm rest extends further than that on the MX 5500's keyboard and this alone makes it more comfortable to use for longer periods of time. The palm rest has anti-bacterial treatment, a boon for sweaty climes such as ours. During use, we noticed that our palms and wrists never felt hot, due to the excellent choice of materials used in the palm rest and maybe also be due to the dimples in the material that cause small air pockets between the material and your hands.

The mouse supplied with the Desktop Wave follows the same black/dark grey colour combo that to our eyes looks classy. The mouse is neatly shaped and ambidextrous. In fact it's so ambidextrous that there is single button above the thumb recess located on both sides. The mouse wheel is also a click button and has tilt capabilities, but this tilt wheel does not look as robust as the unit on the VX Nano or the MX Revolution. The mouse tracking is decent but does not

in any way standout and cannot compare in accuracy to the VX Nano or the MX Revolution. That being said, it's a solid wireless mouse that will satisfy all but the most demanding users.

Priced at Rs. 5,995, the Wave is a great product, but we feel it should have been paired with a better mouse — Logitech has a vast repertoire, after all. The bundled mouse looks great, but does not equal the keyboard's comfort or usability. The fact that it's half the price of the MX 5500 Revolution is a strong plus point, though we did not like the slightly hard feedback on the keys. If Logitech had bundled a better mouse than the LX8 we would heartily recommend this deal.

Logitech V470: Fancy free, receiver-less

The Logitech V470 is a cute looking notebook mouse available in a number of snazzy colours. It's a Bluetooth mouse and does not need a receiver unit since the mouse can pair directly with any device with Bluetooth. 95 per cent of all notebooks and netbooks come with Bluetooth and the major advantage of such a mouse is that a valuable USB port is freed up which would otherwise be occupied with some sort of receiver unit.

The mouse is built to mediocre standards, but when loaded with two AA cells it feels solid, mainly due to the increased weight. The mouse clicks have a positive feel to them but the build quality is obviously a couple of notches below the superb VX Nano. Mouse tracking is good, in fact much better than some of the other wireless mice we've used — no surprise since the V470 uses the same 800 dpi laser sensor that the other Logitech mice — such as the VX Nano, VX Revolution and MX Revolution — use. In fact, we were pretty surprised to see that it's nearly on a par with the MX Revolution when it comes to pin-point accuracy. Logitech has provided this mouse with a good set of smooth Teflon

